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Size and Growth of the United States Crop Insurance Portfolio, 2025

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Francis Tsiboe, Rwit Chakravorty, Hongxi Zhao, Dylan Turner, and Sandro Steinbach

Agricultural Risk Policy Center, North Dakota State University



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Summary

This report documents long-run changes in the size, composition, and structure of the United States Federal Crop Insurance Program (FCIP) from 2006 to 2025. Using administrative records from the U.S. Department of Agriculture's Risk Management Agency, the analysis examines insured liabilities and net reported acres across the program's major commodity groupings; field crops, fruits, nuts, vegetables, nurseries, forage, whole-farm coverage, and a residual other-commodities category. Across nearly all commodity groups, insured liabilities have grown faster than insured acres, a pattern consistent with rising insured values and higher coverage intensity rather than broad acreage expansion. Field crops continue to account for most insured liabilities, while specialty-crop coverage displays heterogeneous growth paths shaped by the distinction between tree (stock) and output policies and by differences in product design. Nursery coverage is the only major group whose insured exposure ended the period below its mid-2000s level. The most pronounced structural change is the expansion of the index-based pasture, rangeland, and forage insurance plan, which simultaneously raised insured acres and liabilities and shifted a larger share of program exposure onto weather-correlated, spatially concentrated risk.

Keywords: crop insurance, insured liabilities, insured acreage, agricultural risk management, field crops, specialty crops, forage insurance

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Key Insights

- **Growth reflects rising insured exposure, not broad acreage expansion.** From 2006 to 2025, FCIP liability growth generally outpaced acreage growth across commodity groups, indicating that program scale has expanded mainly through higher insured values and coverage intensity rather than widespread increases in insured land.
- **Field crops remain the financial anchor of the program.** Corn, soybeans, wheat, cotton, rice, and an aggregate of other field crops continue to account for the largest share of insured liabilities. Their growth path is dominated by higher per-acre insured exposure rather than large gains in insured acres.
- **Specialty-crop growth is heterogeneous across fruits, nuts, vegetables, and nurseries.** Many fruit and vegetable categories combine flat or declining acreage with rising insured values; major nut crops combine acreage expansion with rising per-acre values; fruit and nut tree policies show episodic liability swings against stable acreage bases; and nursery coverage ended the period below its mid-2000s peak even after a partial recovery.
- **Forage coverage marks the largest structural shift in the portfolio.** The rapid expansion of the index-based pasture, rangeland, and forage insurance plan raised both insured acres and liabilities, making forage one of the fastest-growing segments of the program and concentrating a larger share of exposure on weather-correlated, spatially concentrated risk.
- **Recent dollar-valued exposure softened while participation held up.** Between 2024 and 2025, policies, units, and insured acres continued to expand while nominal liabilities, premiums, and subsidies softened, a pattern consistent with lower projected commodity prices compressing insured value per acre rather than a withdrawal from the program.

Introduction

The Federal Crop Insurance Program (FCIP) is a central component of the United States agricultural risk management system, providing protection against yield and revenue losses stemming from weather shocks, price volatility, and other production risks (Baldwin et al., 2023a; Baldwin et al., 2023b; Belasco and Fuller, 2022; Mahul and Stutley, 2010; Smith and Glauber, 2012; Tsiboe and Turner, 2023; Turner et al., 2023; Turner and Tsiboe, 2022). Over the past two decades, the program has expanded well beyond its historical concentration in a small set of field crops to encompass a broader and increasingly diverse portfolio of commodities, production systems, and insurance designs (Gaku and Tsiboe, 2025; Raszap Skorbiansky et al., 2022; Tsiboe et al., 2025; Turner et al., 2023). Understanding how the size and composition of this portfolio have evolved (Risk Management Agency [RMA], 2013; Risk Management Agency [RMA], 2017) is useful for assessing the program's fiscal exposure, its sensitivity to market and climate conditions, and its role within the broader farm safety net (Baldwin et al., 2024; Turner et al., 2023).

Documenting changes in the FCIP book of business is particularly important given the program's influence on producer risk management decisions and the substantial federal resources devoted to its operation (Tsiboe et al., 2026; Congressional Budget Office [CBO], 2017; Congressional Research Service [CRS], 2015; United States Government Accountability Office [GAO], 2014). Changes in insured acreage, insured liabilities, premiums, and subsidies reflect not only participation decisions by producers but also shifts in commodity prices, coverage design, and policy parameters (Hagerman et al., 2025; Tsiboe, 2026; Tsiboe and Steinbach, 2025; Tsiboe and Turner, 2023; Turner et al., 2025; Zhao et al., 2025).

Periods of heightened price volatility can generate large swings in financial metrics even when underlying acreage and participation remain relatively stable, underscoring the need to distinguish nominal growth from structural change when interpreting long-run trends.

This report examines the evolution of the FCIP from 2006 to 2025, a period marked by major changes in agricultural markets, insurance products, and participation patterns. Growth over this period has been uneven across commodities and driven by different mechanisms. In some cases, expansion reflects broader participation and increases in insured acreage; in others, rising insured values, higher coverage intensity, or the expansion of index-based insurance products play a more prominent role. By jointly examining insured liabilities and net reported acres, the analysis clarifies how financial exposure and participation have evolved together.

The analysis is descriptive and institutional in scope. It does not evaluate program effectiveness, estimate causal impacts, or advance policy recommendations. Instead, it provides a consistent empirical baseline intended to support future analytical work and inform policy discussion.

Within this framework, the report addresses three core questions over the 2006–2025 period:

- How has the overall scale of the FCIP book of business evolved in terms of participation, insured acreage, and financial exposure?
- How has the composition of the FCIP portfolio shifted as coverage has expanded beyond traditional field crops into specialty crops, nurseries, and forage systems?
- To what extent has FCIP growth been driven by expanded participation and acreage versus rising insured exposure per acre associated with higher insured values, coverage intensity, and index-based insurance designs?

The descriptive evidence indicates that FCIP growth since 2006 reflects a combination of expanded participation and rising insured exposure per acre, with the relative importance of these forces varying substantially across commodities. At the aggregate level, insured acres expanded modestly while insured liabilities, premiums, subsidies, and indemnities rose sharply in nominal terms; re-basing to 2025 price levels compresses the dollar-valued growth but does not eliminate it, indicating that part of the program's nominal expansion reflects rising commodity prices and part reflects deeper coverage intensity per insured acre. In the most recent year-over-year window (2024 to 2025), participation indicators continued to expand while nominal liabilities and premium-related totals softened, a pattern consistent with lower projected prices reducing insured value per acre even as the breadth of participation held up.

Across commodity groups, three patterns are particularly visible. First, field crops continue to anchor the program financially, but much of their growth is driven by higher insured values and increased coverage intensity rather than large increases in insured acreage. Second, specialty-crop coverage is heterogeneous: fruit and vegetable production tend to combine flat or declining acreage with rising insured values; fruit and nut trees show episodic liability swings against relatively stable acreage bases; nut production combines acreage expansion with rising per-acre exposure; and nursery coverage ended the period well below its mid-2000s peak even after a partial recovery. Third, the most pronounced structural shift occurs in forage coverage, where rapid expansion of the index-based pasture, rangeland, and forage insurance plan layers large participation gains on top of the valuation effects observed elsewhere in the portfolio, shifting a larger share of program exposure onto weather-correlated, spatially

concentrated risk.

Data and Methodology

The analysis draws on the USDA Risk Management Agency (RMA) Summary of Business (SOB), pulled as of October 15, 2026 and used at the commodity level for the national book and commodity-grouping series and at the type, practice, and unit level for finer disaggregation. Two complementary indicators measure program size: insured liability (in nominal U.S. dollars, reported in billions or millions as appropriate to scale) and net reported acres insured (in millions of acres). Insured commodities are assigned to eight RMA-defined groups (field crops, fruits, nuts, vegetables, nurseries, forage, whole-farm coverage, and an "other commodities" residual), with three targeted reclassifications: fruit and nut tree policies are separated from their corresponding output policies (and acreage on tree policies is set to zero to avoid double-counting), and forage is split into yield-based forage only, forage seed, and the index-based Pasture, Rangeland, and Forage (PRF) plan. The sample covers crop years 2006 through 2025, with period-level averages grouped by the three farm bills that bridge the window (2008, 2014, and 2018), and with annual values reported separately for 2024 and 2025.

Results are presented in both nominal terms and 2025 price levels, with the real-terms adjustment based on the USDA NASS Index of Prices Received by Farmers for all-crop agricultural commodities. The analysis is descriptive and institutional and does not estimate causal effects, decompose growth into price-versus-quantity contributions, or advance policy recommendations. A full description of the data sources, the commodity classification rules, the growth-rate construction, the real-terms adjustment, the time-series summary metrics used in the commodity-level sections, and the analysis's scope and limitations is provided in **Appendix A: Data and Methods**.

National Book of Business and Growth

Table 1 reports several metrics that describe the FCIP including the number of policies sold, acres insured, insured liabilities, premiums, subsidies, and indemnities. The data are also decomposed by the three main agricultural legislative periods corresponding to recent farm bills: 2008-13 (2008 Farm Bill), 2014-17 (2014 Farm Bill), and 2018-25 (current 2018 Farm Bill). Additionally, it includes annual data for the crop years 2024 and 2025. The table reflects total crop business for the FCIP which is equal to the sum of additional (Buy-up) and catastrophic (CAT) crop business. Since the beginning of the period under review,

commodity prices have increased substantially, which is reflected in the liability, premium, subsidy, and indemnity amounts. To account for these price changes, values in parentheses are normalized by the producer price index for agricultural goods, re-based to 2025 monetary terms.

Table 1: ***Crop Insurance Book of Business: Net Acres, Policies, and Units in Millions; Dollar Values in Billions.***

	Crop Year Annual Average			Crop Year Totals	
	2008-2013	2014-2017	2018-2025	2024	2025
Policies with Premium	1.17	1.17	1.18	1.21	1.32
Units with Premium	2.66	2.47	2.67	2.85	3.22
Net Acres Insured	273.21	296.16	461.45	542.08	561.30
Endorsed Acres	0.00	4.18	35.31	47.39	87.58
Liability ($)	100.33 (139.40)	104.55 (143.10)	142.44 (170.94)	158.16 (175.25)	157.34 (157.34)
Total Premium ($)	10.21 (14.25)	9.78 (13.39)	14.04 (16.70)	15.76 (17.46)	16.63 (16.63)
Subsidy ($)	6.26 (8.73)	6.11 (8.38)	8.83 (10.50)	9.82 (10.88)	10.48 (10.48)
Indemnity ($)	9.76 (13.24)	6.17 (8.28)	12.43 (14.78)	15.07 (16.70)	11.36 (11.36)
Loss Ratio	0.92	0.63	0.88	0.96	0.68

Note: Values in parentheses are in 2025 U.S. dollars. Loss Ratio = Indemnity / Total Premium.

Source: NDSU Agricultural Risk Policy Center (ARPC) using data from USDA Risk Management Agency Summary of Business as of October 15, 2026.

From 2018 to 2025, FCIP insured an average of $142.44 billion in annual liability for U.S. agricultural producers across all crops (including hay, pasture, range, and forage). Over this same period, the insured area encompassed 461.45 million acres, and the program collected premiums averaging $14.04 billion annually. Additionally, on average, the program paid out $12.43 billion in indemnities to producers each year.

Table 2, which reports average annual growth rates for the same metrics and time periods that Table 1 reports, reveals that the FCIP experienced growth in net acreage insured during the periods from

2008-13, 2014-17, and 2018-25 with annual average growth rates estimated at 1.42 percent, 1.46 percent, and 7.71 percent respectively. In terms of insured liability, the program saw a nominal annual decline of 3.52 percent during 2014-17. Conversely, there was a nominal growth in insured liability during 2008-13 and 2018-25, with average annual increases estimated at 12.77 percent and 5.69 percent, respectively. When liabilities are normalized to 2025 terms, Table 2 shows real growth in liability of 7.27 percent and 0.98 percent during 2008-13 and 2018-25, respectively, but a small decline of 0.11 percent during 2014-17.

Table 2: ***Crop Insurance Book of Business Growth (In Percentage).***

	Crop Year Annual Average			Crop Year Totals	
	2008-2013	2014-2017	2018-2025	2024	2025
Policies with Premium	1.24	-2.02	2.08	-1.02	8.82
Units with Premium	-2.20	-2.15	4.07	-0.46	13.16
Net Acres Insured	1.42	1.46	7.71	0.65	3.54
Endorsed Acres	NA	NA	46.37	1.81	84.81
Liability ($)	12.77 (7.27)	-3.52 (-0.11)	5.69 (0.98)	-12.69 (-15.66)	-0.52 (-10.22)
Total Premium ($)	13.86 (8.18)	-3.57 (-0.16)	7.70 (2.41)	-12.40 (-15.38)	5.52 (-4.77)
Subsidy ($)	14.72 (9.12)	-3.04 (0.41)	7.72 (2.38)	-12.87 (-15.84)	6.69 (-3.72)
Indemnity ($)	45.31 (35.00)	-13.75 (-12.02)	15.83 (10.23)	-14.72 (-17.62)	-24.62 (-31.97)

Note: Values in parentheses are real growth rates.

Source: NDSU Agricultural Risk Policy Center (ARPC) using data from USDA Risk Management Agency Summary of Business as of October 15, 2026.

From 2024 to 2025, participation indicators and monetary exposure moved in opposite directions, reflecting a general softening in commodity prices over the period. Non-monetary measures of participation remained resilient and continued to expand. The number of policies earning premiums was recorded at 1.21 million in 2024 and increased by 8.82 percent to 1.32 million in 2025. Units with premiums rose by 13.16 percent, increasing from 2.85 million in 2024 to 3.22 million in 2025. Net insured acreage expanded by 3.54 percent, rising from 542.08 million acres in 2024 to 561.3 million acres

in 2025, indicating stable to modestly expanding coverage across insured land.

In contrast, financial exposure softened over the same period. Nominal insured liabilities declined by 0.52 percent, falling from $158.16 billion in 2024 to $157.34 billion in 2025. Despite the marginal decline in liabilities, total premiums changed by 5.52 percent, moving from $15.76 billion to $16.63 billion. Total subsidy payments changed by 6.69 percent from $9.82 billion in 2024 to $10.48 billion in 2025.

These movements are consistent with the mechanics of crop insurance pricing. To understand why these metrics can move in different directions, it helps to distinguish liability, total premium, and the producer-paid share of premium. At a high level:

Liability = insured yield × price election × acres × coverage level
Total premium = liability × premium rate
Producer-paid premium = total premium - subsidy

Because different components of this formula can change independently, acres, liability, and total premium do not necessarily move together.

One interpretation consistent with the observed pattern is that projected prices declined between 2024 and 2025 (Chakravorty et al., 2025), reducing insured value per acre even as participation expanded. Lower prices compress liability per acre, so total liabilities can decline slightly even when insured acreage increases. This interpretation is consistent with increasing acres, lower liability per acre, and slightly declining or flat aggregate liability.

At the same time, total premiums can increase if effective premium rates rise. Even with modestly lower aggregate liability, actuarial rate adjustments (Tsiboe et al., 2026), reflecting prior loss experience, updated base rates, regional risk shifts (Perry et al., 2020; Tack et al., 2018; Wang et al., 2021), or movement toward higher coverage levels (e.g., 80–85 percent elections) (Tsiboe, 2026; Yi et al., 2020), can raise the premium rate applied to each dollar of liability. Since total premium equals liability times the effective rate, a higher rate can more than offset a small decline in total liability, resulting in higher aggregate premiums.

Shifts in coverage composition may also contribute. Producers may have selected higher coverage levels or expanded supplemental endorsements (Schnitkey et al., 2020; Schnitkey et al., 2024), which would raise premium per dollar of liability even if average liability per acre declines. Because subsidy payments are a share of total premium, higher total premiums mechanically increase total subsidy outlays even

when insured liabilities soften. The descriptive series reported here do not separately identify the relative contribution of prices, rates, and coverage elections to the year-over-year change.

After normalizing 2024 values to 2025 price levels, the contraction in monetary exposure becomes more pronounced. Table 2 shows real declines of 10.22 percent in insured liabilities, 4.77 percent in total premiums, and 3.72 percent in premium subsidies from 2024 to 2025. These real declines are consistent with lower commodity prices (Chakravorty et al., 2025) reducing insured value per acre, rather than a withdrawal from insurance participation.

At the same time, companion or endorsed acreage, an indicator of supplemental protection layered on top of base coverage, increased sharply by 84.81 percent, rising from 47.39 million acres in 2024 to 87.58 million acres in 2025. This pattern underscores sustained engagement with supplemental endorsements, even as aggregate monetary exposure declined due primarily to price effects.

Program Size and Growth by Commodity Groupings

Over the analyzed period (2006-25), the FCIP offered insurance plans for approximately 158 crops produced in the United States, where a crop refers to any agricultural commodity for which RMA has established an insurance product, regardless of whether it is actively insured each year. This section of the report details the FCIP's coverage in terms of net insured acreage and total liability for these crops, which are categorized into eight groups: field crops, fruits (trees and output), nuts (trees and output), forage, vegetables, nursery products, whole farm coverage, and an aggregate other commodities group that captures any remaining commodities not explicitly assigned to a category. Of these 158 crops for which insurance products exist, the number with active participation (referred to here as insurable crops) increased from 114 in 2006 to 127 in 2025, an 11.4 percent increase. Within those actively insured crops, the number of distinct crop/type combinations, which reflect finer classifications such as variety, intended use, or class recognized separately by RMA for rating and coverage purposes, increased by 57.14 percent, from 28 in 2006 to 44 in 2025. The insured liabilities and acreage attributable to these eight groups are shown in Figure 1. Over the period analyzed, FCIP insured acreage associated with crop production grew from 242.8 million acres in 2006 to 561.3 million acres in 2025, while insured liabilities grew from $49.89 billion to $157.34 billion over the same period.

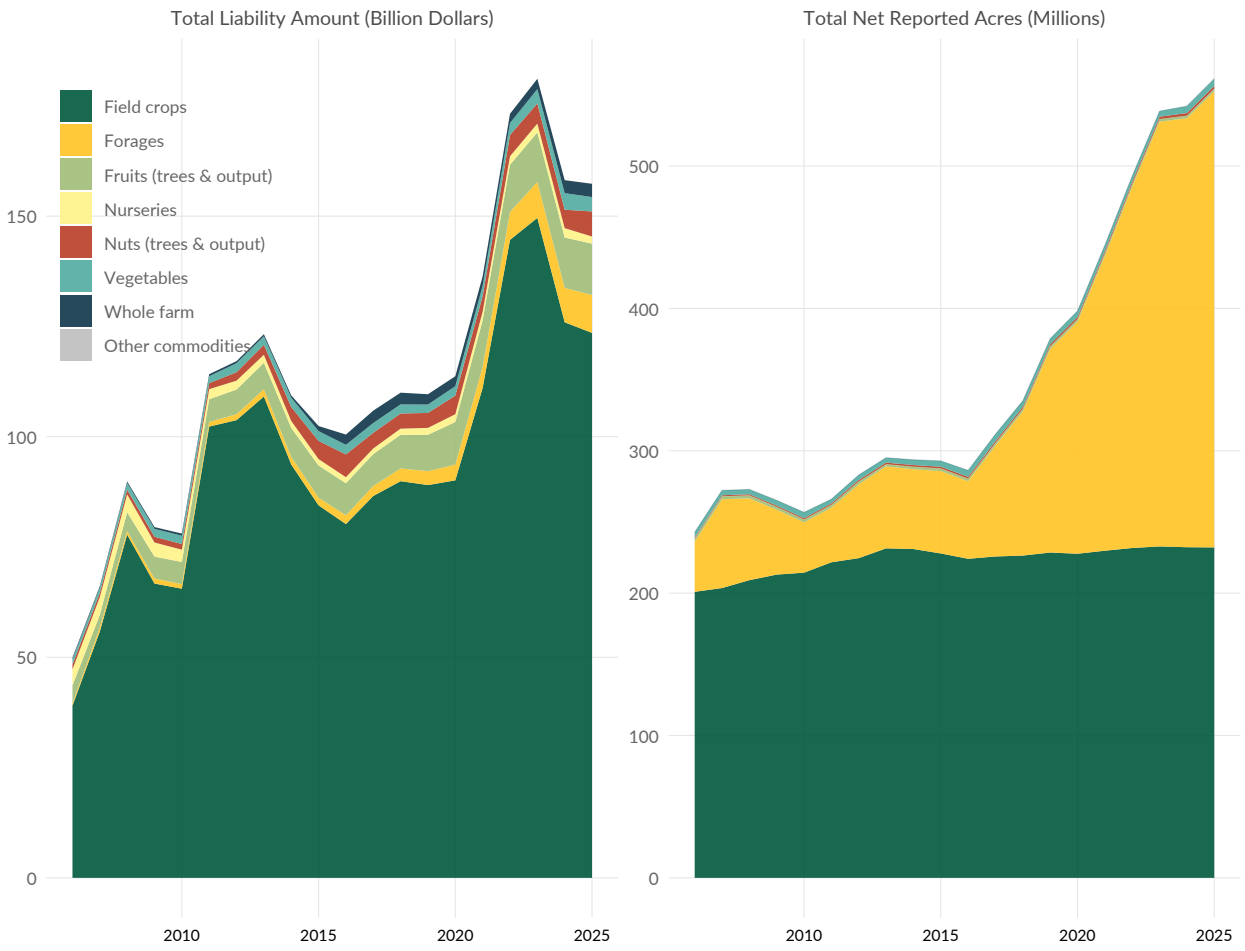
Since 2006, field crops have consistently represented the largest contribution to total insured liabilities within the FCIP. Liabilities for Field crops grew from $39.04 billion in 2006 (78.25 percent of total) to

$123.53 billion in 2025 (78.51 percent of total). The fruits and nuts categories have also seen steady growth in liability. From 2006-25, insured liabilities for fruits rose from $4.05 billion (8.12 percent of total) to $11.64 billion (7.4 percent of total) while insured liabilities for nuts grew from $1.08 billion (2.16 percent of total) to $5.68 billion (3.61 percent of total) over the same period. Forage liability grew from $0.5 billion (1 percent of total) to $8.59 billion (5.46 percent of total). Nursery products is the only category to have insured liabilities that were higher in 2006 relative to 2025 going from $3.67 billion in 2006 (7.36 percent of total) to $1.62 billion in 2025 (1.03 percent of total). Vegetables saw a moderate rise, with liability growing from $1.19 billion (2.39 percent of total) to $3.26 billion (2.07 percent of total). Lastly, whole farm coverage liability grew from $0.35 billion (0.71 percent of total) to $3.01 billion (1.91 percent of total).

Across commodity categories, liability growth has generally outpaced acreage growth, reflecting the increasing role of rising insured values, higher coverage intensity, and sensitivity to commodity price cycles in shaping program exposure, a pattern that holds for field crops, specialty crops, and forage alike, though the mechanisms and magnitudes differ. The most pronounced departure from this general pattern occurs in forage, where acreage itself expanded dramatically due to the introduction and rapid uptake of the index-based pasture, rangeland, and forage insurance plan, layering large participation gains on top of the valuation effects observed elsewhere in the portfolio (Turner et al., 2023). Across all commodities, acreage covered by the FCIP expanded significantly, rising from 242.8 million acres in 2006 to 561.3 million acres by 2025 with insured acres under forage crops increasing from 35.19 million acres in 2006 (14.49 percent) to 320.5 million acres in 2025 (57.1 percent).[1] In 2006, field crops accounted for 82.76 percent of total insured acres. By 2025, field crops had increased in terms of actual insured acres but declined in relative terms to represent 41.35 percent of insured acres. Coverage for vegetables, which have traditionally represented a smaller portion of insured acres, also saw an increase; from 3.78 million acres in 2006 (1.56 percent of total) to 5.03 million acres in 2025 (0.9 percent of total). From 2006-2025, insured acreage for fruits fell from 2.19 million (0.9 percent of total) to 1.73 million (0.31 percent of total) while insured acreage for nuts grew from 0.71 million (0.29 percent of total) to 1.92 million (0.34 percent of total) over the same period.

[1] The contrast between forage crops representing a relatively small share of insured liability, but a large share of insured acreage is due to forage crops having a relatively low value per acre compared to other crops.

Figure 1: ***United States Insurance Program Liability and Net Acres Insured by Commodity Type.***



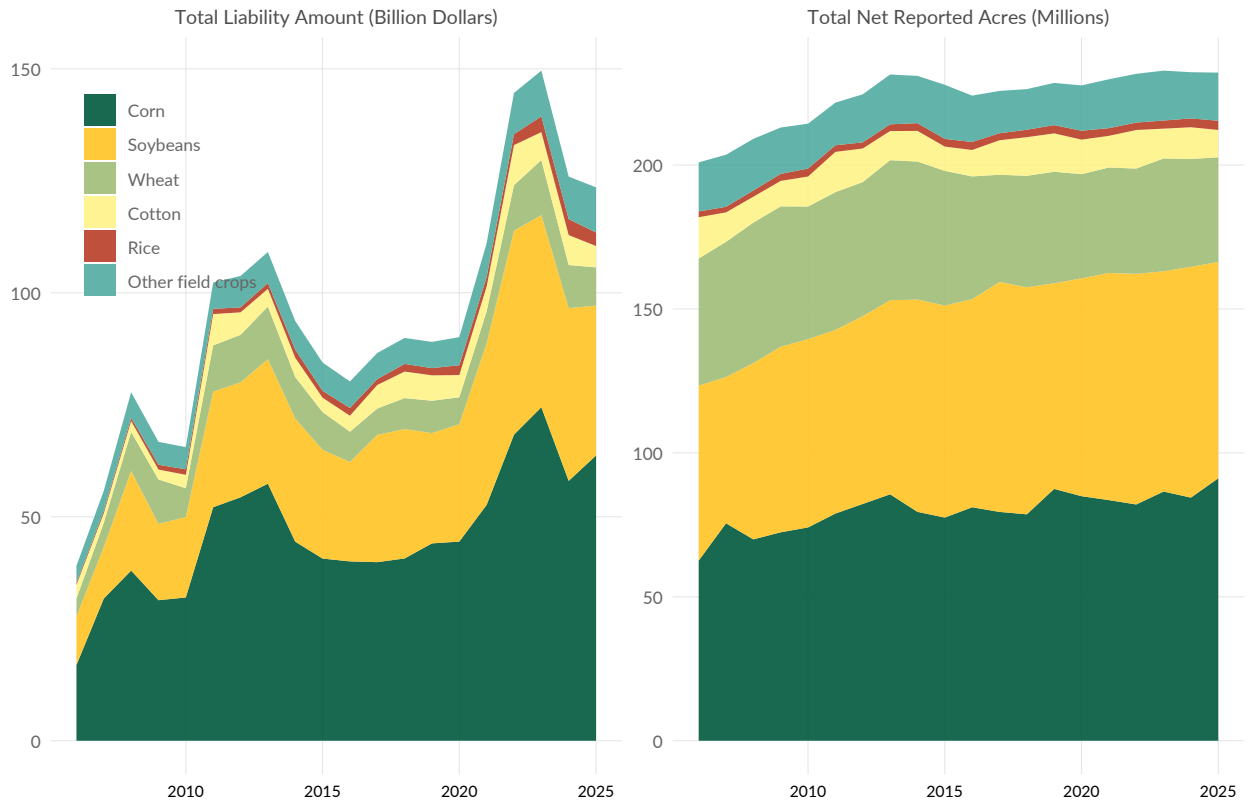
Note: Commodity groups are based on RMA crop definitions. Field crops include major grains, oilseeds, fiber crops, and other row crops. Fruits and nuts include both production and tree policies where applicable. Forages include forage, forage seed, and pasture, rangeland, and forage. Nurseries include field-grown, container, and nursery value select coverage. Vegetables include major fresh and processing vegetable crops. Whole farm includes Adjusted Gross Revenue, Adjusted Gross Revenue-Lite, Whole-Farm Revenue Protection, and Micro Farm. Other commodities include remaining crops, prevented planting, and combined crop categories not otherwise classified

Source: NDSU Agricultural Risk Policy Center (ARPC) using data from USDA Risk Management Agency Summary of Business as of October 15, 2026.

Program Size and Growth for Field Crops

As shown in the previous section, field crops account for a substantial share of FCIP insured acreage and liabilities, but exposure is concentrated in five commodities (corn, soybeans, wheat, cotton, and rice) with all remaining crops grouped as "other field crops." Figure 2 summarizes insured liabilities and insured acreage for these commodities from 2006 to 2025.

Figure 2: ***United States Insurance Program Liability and Net Acres Insured for Field Crops.***



Note: Other crops includes barley, buckwheat, camelina, canola, flax, hemp, millet, oats, peanuts, potatoes, safflower, sesame, sorghum, sugar beets, sugarcane, sunflowers, tobacco, and triticale.

Source: NDSU Agricultural Risk Policy Center (ARPC) using data from USDA Risk Management Agency Summary of Business as of October 15, 2026.

Corn remains the dominant field crop across the entire sample. Insured corn liabilities rose from $16.9 billion in 2006 to $63.68 billion in 2025, peaking in 2023 at $74.46 billion. However, this growth was not smooth; large step-ups occurred in 2007: +87.8 percent; 2008: +19.7 percent; 2011: +63.0 percent; 2021: +18.4 percent; 2022: +29.8 percent, followed by notable pullbacks in 2009: -17.4 percent; 2014: -22.5 percent; 2024: -22.1 percent. Corn acreage grew more gradually, increasing from 62.56 million

acres in 2006 to 91.17 million acres in 2025 (with peak acreage in 2025). The contrast between faster liability growth (average annual growth rate 7.23 percent) and slower acreage growth (2 percent) highlights the increasing role of insured value and coverage intensity in shaping program exposure.

Soybeans consistently represent the second pillar of FCIP field crop insurance. Soybeans liabilities increased from $10.84 billion in 2006 to $33.45 billion in 2025, peaking in 2022 at $45.53 billion. The series features prominent surges in 2008: +92.7 percent; 2011: +43.6 percent; 2017: +28.1 percent; 2021: +37.6 percent; 2022: +26.2 percent, with reversals in 2009: -23.3 percent; 2015: -11.6 percent; 2019: -14.8 percent; 2024: -10.1 percent; 2025: -13.3 percent. Soybeans acreage expanded more modestly, from 60.8 million acres to 75.18 million acres, reinforcing that liabilities have grown faster than acres (mean annual growth 6.11 percent versus acreage growth 1.12 percent).

Wheat follows a different structural trajectory. Wheat liabilities rose from $4 billion in 2006 to $8.55 billion in 2025, reaching a peak in 2023 at $12.31 billion. Unlike corn and soybeans, wheat's liability path is more episodic, with sharp expansions in 2007: +34.5 percent; 2008: +62.4 percent; 2009: +13.4 percent; 2011: +60.8 percent; 2013: +10.8 percent; 2018: +17.2 percent; 2021: +19.2 percent; 2022: +42.3 percent; 2023: +21.0 percent and sizable drawdowns in 2010: -35.1 percent; 2014: -21.1 percent; 2016: -19.5 percent; 2017: -13.1 percent; 2020: -17.0 percent; 2024: -21.9 percent; 2025: -11.0 percent. Meanwhile, wheat acreage declined from 44.14 million acres in 2006 to 36.35 million acres in 2025 (mean annual change -1.02 percent), indicating that wheat exposure is increasingly shaped by per-acre insured values amid contraction in insured land.

Cotton contributes a smaller share of field crop liabilities but exhibits pronounced boom-bust dynamics. Cotton liabilities increased from $3.07 billion in 2006 to $4.76 billion in 2025, peaking in 2022 at $8.93 billion. The series includes outsized jumps in 2008: +12.9 percent; 2010: +35.0 percent; 2011: +133.7 percent; 2016: +11.1 percent; 2017: +47.4 percent; 2018: +12.8 percent; 2021: +11.7 percent; 2022: +61.2 percent and sharp reversals in 2007: -29.9 percent; 2012: -28.0 percent; 2013: -21.9 percent; 2015: -25.4 percent; 2020: -12.5 percent; 2023: -30.3 percent; 2025: -28.9 percent. Over the same period, cotton acreage contracted from 14.36 million acres to 9.49 million acres, reinforcing that shifts in insured value and market conditions can dominate acreage in shaping liability exposure.

Rice remains small in acreage but showed the fastest proportional growth in liabilities. Rice liabilities rise from $0.44 billion in 2006 to $3.02 billion in 2025, peaking in 2024 at $3.56 billion. This growth was driven by repeated expansions (2007: +21.7 percent; 2008: +33.4 percent; 2009: +50.0 percent; 2010: +14.2 percent; 2013: +16.7 percent; 2014: +39.1 percent; 2016: +14.0 percent; 2018: +30.7 percent;

2020: +36.1 percent; 2022: +15.7 percent; 2023: +43.6 percent) with comparatively fewer major reversals (2015: -15.1 percent; 2017: -25.1 percent; 2025: -15.4 percent). Rice acreage increased from 2 million acres to 3.22 million acres, consistent with gradual expansion alongside rapidly rising insured exposure (mean annual growth 10.63 percent).

Finally, the aggregated "other field crops" category shows steady growth in insured liabilities despite relatively flat insured acreage. Its liabilities increased from $3.79 billion in 2006 to $10.07 billion in 2025, peaking in 2023 at $10.22 billion, while acreage remains broadly stable from 17.05 million acres to 16.71 million acres. This combination reinforces the broader theme of the period: FCIP field crop growth is increasingly reflected in higher insured values and coverage intensity rather than expansion in insured acreage alone.

For field crops, 2006 to 2025 period reveals a field crop insurance portfolio that remains stable in its commodity composition while expanding markedly on a financial scale. The persistent gap between liability growth and acreage growth across most crops underscores a structural shift toward higher insured values and coverage intensity, shaping FCIP exposure independently of changes in insured acreage alone.

Program Size and Growth for Fruits

Like field crops, a large portion of the total liability and acreage attributable to fruits is represented by several commodities. For the same acreage, the FCIP allows producers to insure the stock (trees) and output (production quantity) of commodities in this category under separate policies. Figure 3 shows insured liability for policies that protected fruit trees broken down by specific commodities, and Figure 4 shows the liability and acreage for policies that protected fruit production. [2]

[2] The fruit of the commodity is either measured on an area basis (i.e., yield = amount produced per acre) or as quantity. Among the commodities covered in 2025, raisins are the only commodity whose quantity insured was stated in tons. All other commodities had their quantity insured stated in acres.

Fruit Trees

Fruit trees represent a distinct and smaller segment of FCIP participation, characterized by relatively stable acreage bases and liability growth that is often episodic and closely tied to market conditions, disease pressure, and structural adjustment within perennial systems. Figure 3 summarizes insured liabilities for major fruit tree categories from 2006 to 2025. Compared with annual fruit production, fruit tree liabilities tend to exhibit greater volatility and weaker long-run trends, a pattern that may reflect the slower adjustment dynamics characteristic of perennial systems, though the liability and acreage series alone do not permit a definitive attribution.

Orange trees account for the largest share of fruit tree liabilities throughout the sample. Insured orange tree liabilities increase modestly from $1.17 billion to $1.18 billion, peaking in 2020 at $2.28 billion. The series is marked by pronounced swings, including a sharp expansion in 2013: +18.8 percent; 2019: +13.3 percent; 2020: +79.6 percent followed by sizable contractions in 2017: -11.4 percent; 2023: -11.1 percent; 2024: -26.7 percent; 2025: -11.7 percent. Despite these fluctuations, the net change over the period is limited, indicating that liability growth has been uneven rather than steadily increasing.

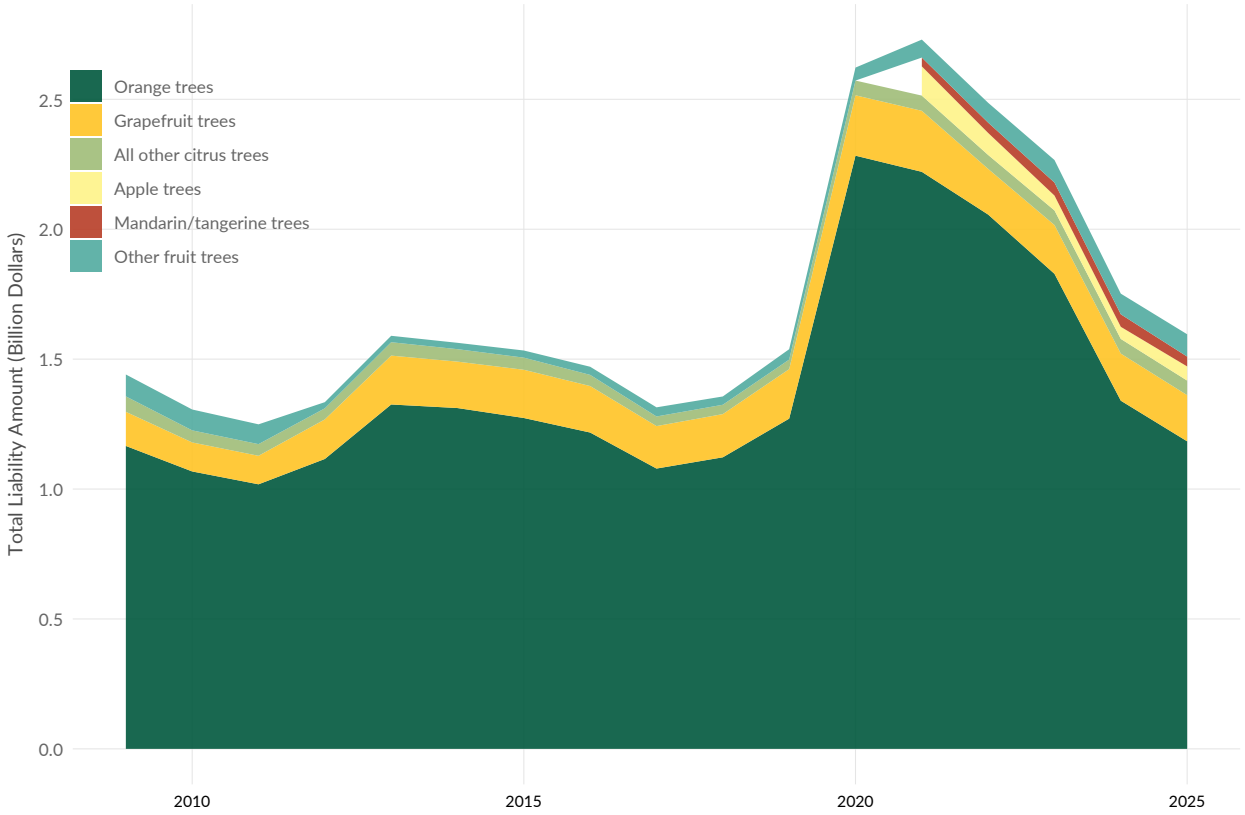
Grapefruit trees form the second-largest fruit tree category. Insured liabilities rose from $131.33 million to $177.72 million, with a peak in 2021. Growth episodes in 2012: +38.8 percent; 2013: +23.5 percent; 2019: +14.6 percent; 2020: +22.0 percent are interspersed with meaningful declines, particularly in 2010: -15.0 percent; 2022: -25.1 percent, yielding a modest upward trend.

Apple trees exhibit a contrasting pattern of contraction. Insured apple tree liabilities decline from $112.44 million to $54.48 million, with repeated drawdowns in 2022: -24.6 percent; 2023: -32.5 percent; 2024: -18.5 percent. Although a brief rebound occurred in 2025: +16.9 percent, the overall trend is negative, suggesting reduced insured exposure within this category over time.

Smaller citrus tree categories display heterogeneous behavior. All other citrus trees experience a gradual decline in liabilities from $59.46 million to $55.99 million, despite intermittent growth episodes (2013: +20.8 percent; 2020: +54.2 percent). Mandarin and tangerine trees enter later in the sample and remain small in scale, with liabilities rising from $34 million to $37.91 million before declining in the most recent year.

Other fruit trees show limited net change but substantial volatility. Liabilities begin at $84.28 million and end at $85.9 million, peaking in 2023. Large year-to-year swings, including a sharp contraction in 2012, offset periods of rapid growth, resulting in no strong long-run trend.

Figure 3: ***United States Insurance Program Liability for Fruit Trees.***



Note: Other crops includes avocado trees, banana tree, carambola trees, lemon trees, lime trees, mango trees, papaya tree, and tangerine trees.

Source: NDSU Agricultural Risk Policy Center (ARPC) using data from USDA Risk Management Agency Summary of Business as of October 15, 2026.

Fruit Production

Fruit production represents a smaller share of FCIP liabilities and acreage than field crops, but the portfolio has expanded steadily over time, with growth driven primarily by rising insured values rather than increases in insured acreage. Figure 4 summarizes insured liabilities and insured acreage for major fruit commodities from 2006 to 2025. Across fruits, liability growth is broad-based but heterogeneous, reflecting differences in market conditions, production risk, and structural change within individual industries.

Grapes represent the largest fruit liability category throughout the sample. Insured grape liabilities increased from $833.93 million in 2006 to $2.92 billion in 2025, peaking in 2024 at $2.94 billion. Growth is highly persistent, with repeated expansions in 2009: +14.7 percent; 2013: +24.8 percent; 2014: +17.3 percent; 2021: +18.1 percent and no major sustained drawdowns. In contrast, insured grape acreage trends downward, declining from 651.61 thousand acres to 561.65 thousand acres, underscoring a clear rise in insured exposure per acre.

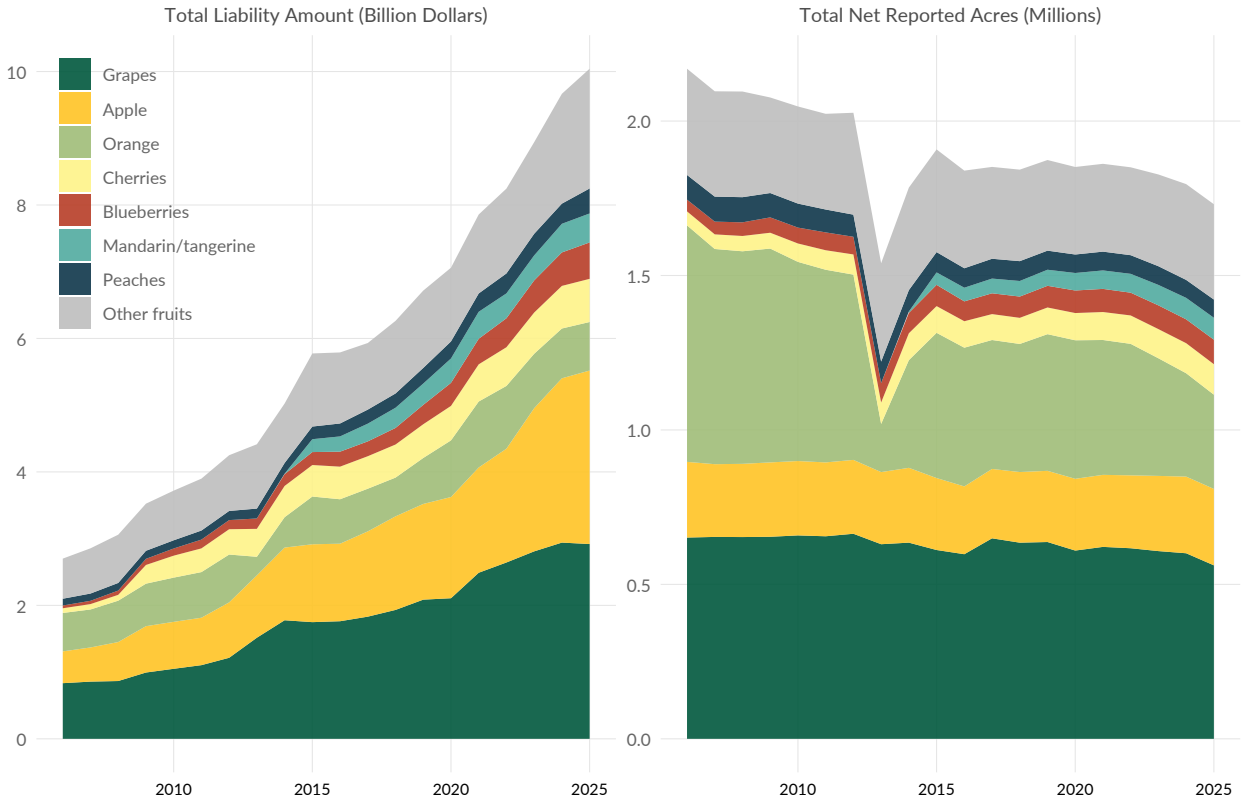
Apples exhibit one of the fastest-growing liability profiles among fruit crops. Insured apple liabilities rose from $476.39 million in 2006 to $2.6 billion in 2025, reaching a maximum in 2025. Liability growth accelerates notably after the mid-2010s (2008: +14.1 percent; 2009: +18.9 percent; 2012: +16.8 percent; 2013: +12.5 percent; 2014: +16.6 percent; 2023: +25.8 percent; 2024: +14.8 percent), while insured acreage remains essentially flat, moving from 245.05 to 247.42 thousand acres over the period.

Citrus crops display more divergent patterns. Orange liabilities rose modestly from $575.74 million to $727.4 million, but with substantial volatility, including a sharp contraction in 2013 followed by partial recovery. Over the same period, insured orange acreage declines sharply from 765.64 to 305.03 thousand acres, reflecting structural contraction in the industry despite periods of rising insured value.

Several smaller fruit crops exhibit rapid proportional growth from a very small initial base. Cherry liabilities increased from $70.53 million to $646.78 million, with especially large early expansions (2007: +14.2 percent; 2009: +220.8 percent; 2010: +17.6 percent; 2013: +10.3 percent; 2014: +11.8 percent). Blueberries show a similarly strong trajectory, rising from $41.16 million to $545.45 million by 2025, supported by consistent year-over-year growth.

In both cases, acreage increases, from 45.3 to 98.7 thousand acres for cherries, and from 37.94 to 79.4 thousand acres for blueberries, but at a slower pace than liabilities.

Figure 4: ***United States Insurance Program Liability and Net Acres Insured for Fruit Production.***



Note: Other crops includes apricot, avocado, banana, caneberries, cranberries, figs, grapefruit, grapevine, kiwifruit, lemon, nectarine, olives, papaya, pears, plum, pomegranates, processing freestone, prunes, raisins, strawberries, tangelo, and tangors.

Source: NDSU Agricultural Risk Policy Center (ARPC) using data from USDA Risk Management Agency Summary of Business as of October 15, 2026.

Peaches remain a smaller but steadily expanding liability category. Insured peach liabilities increased from $101.62 million in 2006 to $374.43 million in 2025, reaching their maximum in 2025 at $374.43 million. Notable increases occurred in 2011: +10.8 percent; 2015: +18.2 percent; 2025: +23.8 percent. In contrast, insured peach acreage declined over the period, from 79.92 thousand acres to 58.9 thousand acres, indicating that growth has been driven primarily by rising insured exposure per acre rather than expanded acreage participation.

Mandarin and tangerine production enter the program later in the sample but expanded rapidly. Insured liabilities grew from $7.02 million to $434.51 million by 2025, mirrored by acreage growth from 4.57 to 71 thousand acres. Although small in absolute scale, this category records the fastest relative expansion among fruits.

Other fruits, taken as an aggregate group, also show steady expansion in insured liabilities. Liabilities increased from $601.31 million in 2006 to $1.79 billion in 2025. Insured acreage for this group trends modestly downward over time, reinforcing the pattern that liability growth reflects higher insured values rather than expanded participation.

The fruit portfolio exhibits a consistent structural pattern across both tree and production policies: insured exposure has increased primarily through higher insured values per acre rather than broad expansion in insured land. Fruit trees show limited long-run growth and heightened volatility. Acreage in most tree categories changes slowly over the period, and liability swings are episodic rather than trend-driven, a pattern consistent with the slower adjustment dynamics of perennial systems, though the specific drivers are not directly observable in the liability and acreage series. In contrast, fruit production liabilities have expanded more steadily, particularly for grapes, apples, berries, and emerging citrus categories, even as acreage remains flat or contracts for many commodities. This divergence underscores the FCIP's growing sensitivity to price movements and coverage intensity within perennial crop categories. The acreage series suggest that participation levels adjust slowly in these systems, while liability series can shift substantially within short periods, indicating that financial exposure responds to forces (most plausibly price and coverage elections) that operate independently of land use change.

Program Size and Growth for Nuts

Like the fruit category, the FCIP allows nut producers to insure the stock (trees) and output (production quantity) of commodities in this category under separate policies. Figure 5 shows insured liability for

policies that protected nut trees broken down by specific commodities, and Figure 6 shows the liability and acreage for policies that protected nut output.

Nut Trees

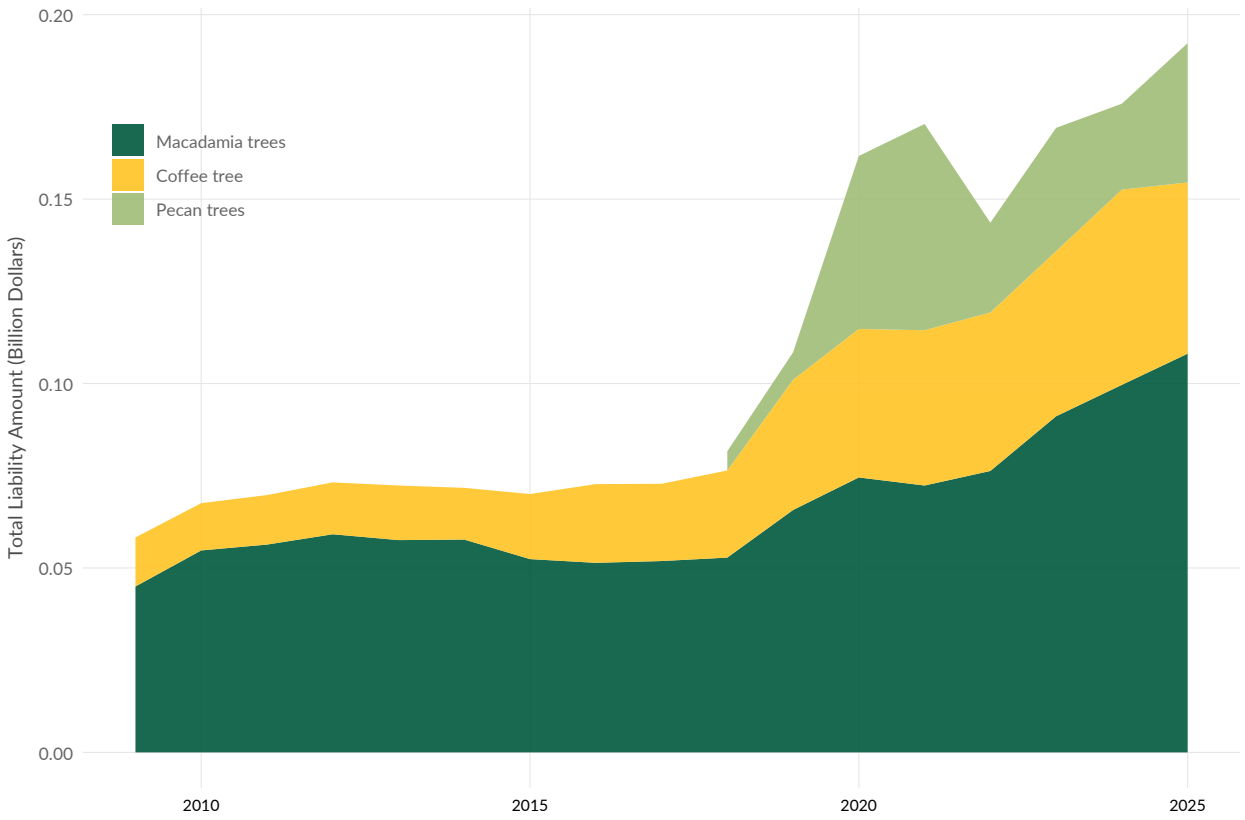
Nut trees account for a small but rapidly evolving segment of FCIP liabilities, with growth patterns that differ sharply across crops. Unlike fruit trees, several nut tree categories exhibit sustained upward movement over the period, albeit from very small initial bases. Figure 5 summarizes insured liabilities for major nut tree categories from 2006 to 2025.

Macadamia trees dominate nut tree participation throughout the sample. Insured macadamia liabilities rise steadily from $44.98 million to $108.09 million, reaching a peak in 2025. Growth is relatively smooth compared with other specialty crops, punctuated by moderate expansion episodes in 2010: +21.7 percent; 2019: +24.4 percent; 2020: +13.4 percent; 2023: +19.4 percent. The absence of major drawdowns and a strong positive trend indicate gradual but persistent deepening of insured exposure in this category.

Pecan trees exhibit the most volatile liability trajectory. Insured liabilities increased from $5.2 million to $37.77 million, but the path is dominated by sharp spikes and contractions. A dramatic surge in 2019: +42.8 percent; 2020: +531.1 percent; 2021: +19.2 percent; 2023: +37.3 percent; 2025: +62.1 percent is followed by steep declines in 2022: -56.5 percent; 2024: -30.3 percent, resulting in large year-to-year swings and a weak long-run trend despite high cumulative growth.

Coffee trees represent a smaller but increasingly stable component of nut tree liabilities. Insured coffee liabilities rose from $13.3 million to $46.42 million, peaking in 2024. Growth is driven by repeated moderate expansions in 2015: +25.8 percent; 2016: +21.0 percent; 2018: +12.8 percent; 2019: +49.4 percent; 2020: +14.0 percent; 2024: +18.2 percent, with limited drawdowns and a strong positive trend, suggesting gradual integration of coffee into insured perennial systems.

Figure 5: ***United States Insurance Program Liability for Nut Trees.***



Source: NDSU Agricultural Risk Policy Center (ARPC) using data from USDA Risk Management Agency Summary of Business as of October 15, 2026.

Nut Production

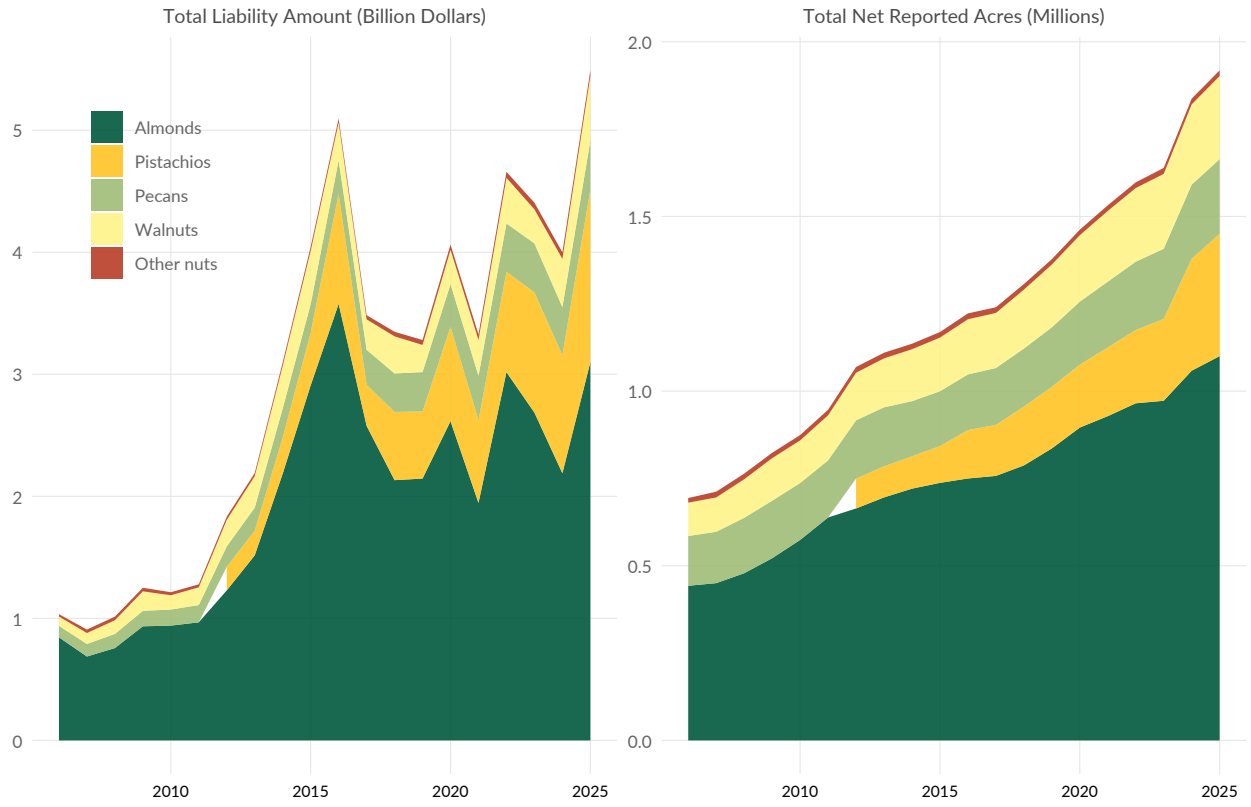
Nut production represents one of the most dynamic components of FCIP specialty crop coverage. Unlike fruit trees, nut crops combine long-run acreage expansion with large swings in insured values, resulting in rapid liability growth that is both structural and cyclical. Figure 6 summarizes insured liabilities and acreage for major nut crops from 2006 to 2025.

Almonds dominate nut production throughout the sample and account for most of nut-related liabilities. Insured almond liabilities rose from $844.72 million in 2006 to $3.1 billion in 2025, peaking in 2016 at $3.58 billion. Growth is uneven, with pronounced expansions during high-price periods (2008: +10.1 percent; 2009: +23.6 percent; 2012: +27.1 percent; 2013: +23.3 percent; 2014: +44.1 percent; 2015: +33.1 percent; 2016: +23.0 percent; 2020: +21.9 percent; 2022: +55.1 percent; 2025: +41.6 percent) and sharp corrections (2007: -18.6 percent; 2017: -28.0 percent; 2018: -17.3 percent; 2021: -25.6 percent; 2023: -11.0 percent; 2024: -18.5 percent). At the same time, insured almond acreage expands steadily from 442.66 thousand acres to 1.1 million acres, indicating that liability growth reflects both acreage expansion and rising insured values per acre.

Pistachios exhibit the fastest proportional growth among major nut crops. Insured liabilities increased from $193.52 million to $1.41 billion, reaching a maximum in 2025. The series is highly volatile, with large step increases in 2014: +46.9 percent; 2015: +45.7 percent; 2016: +108.5 percent; 2018: +65.9 percent; 2020: +40.6 percent; 2022: +21.2 percent; 2023: +19.7 percent; 2025: +46.2 percent followed by episodic contractions, a pattern consistent with the lagged supply responses characteristic of orchard crops, though these mechanisms are not directly observed in the data. Acreage growth is substantial and monotonic, rising from 85.53 to 350.3 thousand acres, reinforcing the expanding role of pistachios within the program.

Walnuts show steady, long-run growth with moderate volatility. Insured walnut liabilities increased from $75.85 million to $529.51 million by 2025, peaking in 2025. Growth episodes are frequent (2007: +18.2 percent; 2008: +24.8 percent; 2009: +42.9 percent; 2011: +24.4 percent; 2012: +49.4 percent; 2013: +18.6 percent; 2014: +35.5 percent; 2015: +25.0 percent; 2018: +21.8 percent; 2020: +26.2 percent; 2022: +27.2 percent; 2024: +41.9 percent; 2025: +34.1 percent) but are occasionally offset by sizable drawdowns (2010: -26.9 percent; 2016: -29.5 percent; 2017: -18.9 percent; 2019: -26.8 percent; 2023: -25.5 percent). Insured acreage nearly triples over the period (from 95.56 to 237.81 thousand acres) suggesting a combination of structural expansion and intensifying coverage.

Figure 6: ***United States Insurance Program Liability and Net Acres Insured for Nuts Production.***



Note: Other crops includes coffee, and macadamia nuts.

Source: NDSU Agricultural Risk Policy Center (ARPC) using data from USDA Risk Management Agency Summary of Business as of October 15, 2026.

Pecans present a more gradual and stable profile. Insured pecan liabilities rise from $94.75 million to $402.36 million, with relatively few sharp declines and a strong positive trend. Acreage growth is modest but persistent, increasing from 142.45 to 213.62 thousand acres, indicating slow but consistent integration into FCIP coverage.

Other nuts remain small in absolute scale but grow steadily over time. Insured liabilities increased from $19.18 million to $46.68 million, while insured acreage edges up from 13.26 to 16.39 thousand acres. Growth is incremental rather than episodic, contributing little to aggregate scale but reinforcing the broader expansion of nut production coverage.

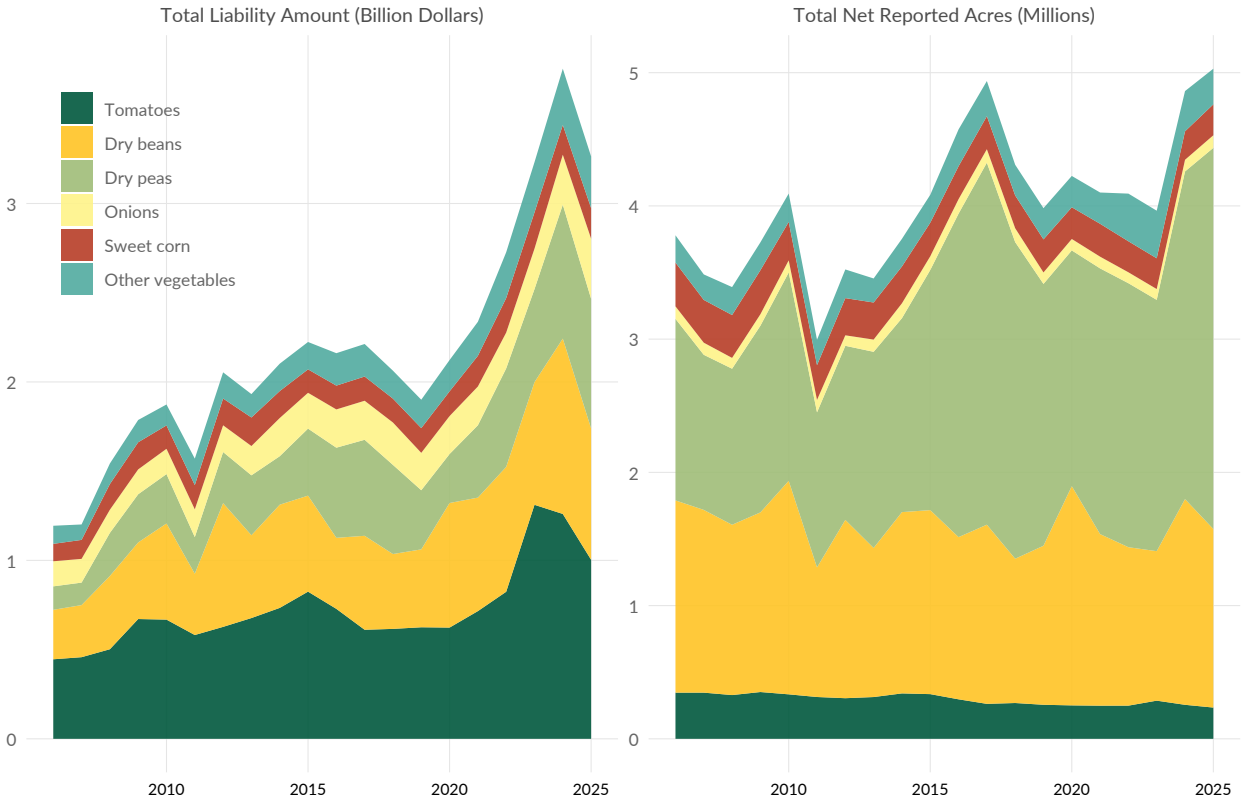
Across both nut trees and nut production, FCIP growth reflects a clear pattern of structural expansion rather than simple valuation effects. Nut trees remain small in absolute scale but show gradual integration into the program, with sustained growth in macadamia and coffee trees and more volatile, episodic participation in pecans. Nut production, by contrast, exhibits rapid and durable expansion, driven by a combination of rising insured acreage and increasing insured values, most notably for almonds and pistachios. These trends indicate that nuts represent one of the most dynamic specialty crop segments in FCIP, with expanding long-term exposure and heightened sensitivity to price cycles and yield variability. The combination of rising acreage and episodic liability swings in several nut categories is consistent with both structural participation growth and valuation effects, though the relative contribution of each force varies across crops and years in ways the aggregate series does not fully resolve.

Program Size and Growth for Vegetables

Vegetable production occupies a middle ground within FCIP: larger and more diverse than most specialty crops, but smaller and more volatile than major field crops. Over 2006–2025, insured vegetable liabilities increased across nearly all commodities, while insured acreage patterns diverged, expanding for some crops and contracting or remaining flat for others. Figure 7 summarizes insured liabilities and acreage for major vegetables.

Tomatoes represent the largest vegetable liability category throughout the period. Insured tomato liabilities rose from $445.73 million in 2006 to $1 billion in 2025, peaking in 2023 at $1.31 billion. Growth is uneven, with strong expansions in 2009: +33.7 percent; 2015: +12.4 percent; 2021: +14.8 percent; 2022: +15.2 percent; 2023: +59.1 percent followed by sizable drawdowns. In contrast, insured tomato acreage declined steadily from 346.69 to 234.64 thousand acres, indicating rising insured

Figure 7: ***United States Insurance Program Liability and Net Acres Insured for Vegetable Production.***



Note: Other crops includes cabbage, chile peppers, clary sage, cucumbers, fresh market beans, hybrid vegetable seed, mint, mustard, peppers, processing beans, pumpkins, and sweet potatoes.

Source: NDSU Agricultural Risk Policy Center (ARPC) using data from USDA Risk Management Agency Summary of Business as of October 15, 2026.

exposure per acre rather than expanded participation.

Dry beans show substantial liability growth despite largely stagnant acreage. Insured liabilities increased from $277.29 million to $735.89 million, with sharp growth episodes in 2008: +40.6 percent; 2010: +25.5 percent; 2012: +101.8 percent; 2014: +24.6 percent; 2017: +32.3 percent; 2020: +59.9 percent; 2022: +10.0 percent; 2024: +42.9 percent offset by frequent contractions. Insured acreage fluctuates over time but shows no sustained upward trend, remaining near 1340.35 thousand acres by 2025.

Dry peas exhibit one of the strongest growth profiles among vegetables. Insured liabilities rose from $131.38 million to $726.57 million, peaking in 2024. Liability growth is supported by consistent acreage expansion, with insured area increasing from 1362.86 to 2860.69 thousand acres, making dry peas one of the few vegetable crops where acreage growth and rising insured values reinforce one another.

Onions display steady, moderate growth. Insured onion liabilities increased from $140.64 million to $337.08 million, reaching their highest level in 2025. Insured acreage remained essentially flat over this period, moving from 93.81 to 94.51 thousand acres, suggesting gradual deepening of coverage rather than expanded land use.

Sweet corn shows relatively modest liability growth compared with other vegetables. Insured liabilities rose from $97.59 million to $171.1 million, with intermittent gains and declines. Insured acreage trended downward over time, declining from 328.78 to 232.11 thousand acres, reinforcing the role of rising insured values per acre in supporting liability growth.

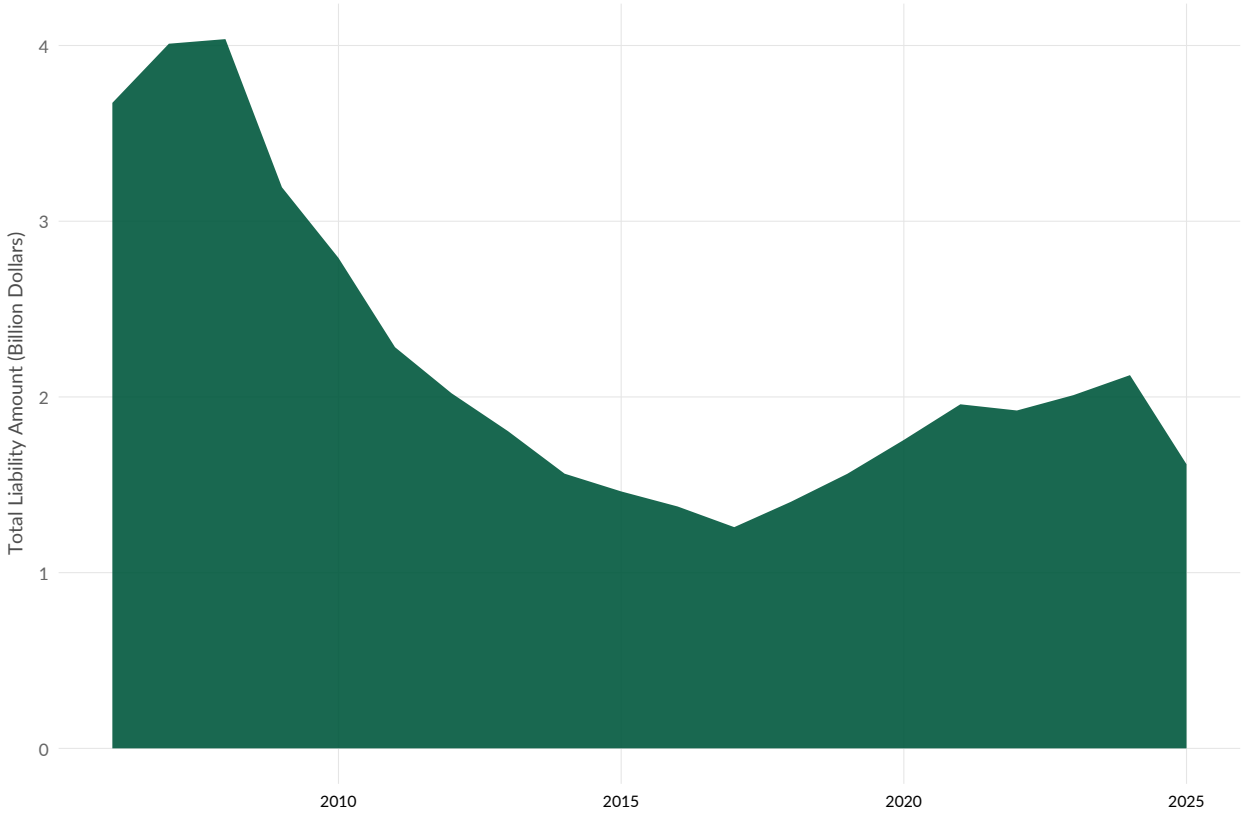
Other vegetables, taken as an aggregate group, also exhibit steady expansion. Insured liabilities increased from $101.41 million to $289.62 million, with notable growth episodes in 2008: +33.1 percent; 2011: +26.4 percent; 2014: +17.1 percent; 2016: +18.5 percent; 2020: +10.3 percent; 2022: +34.7 percent; 2024: +12.0 percent. Insured acreage increased modestly over time, ending at 267.5 thousand acres, contributing incremental growth to the overall vegetable portfolio.

Vegetable production mirrors broader FCIP trends observed in other specialty crops: insured liabilities rose persistently over 2006–2025, while acreage responses are heterogeneous. Growth is driven primarily by higher insured values and episodic price and yield shocks, with only select crops, most notably dry peas, exhibiting sustained acreage expansion alongside rising liabilities.

Program Size and Growth for Nurseries

In addition to traditional field and specialty crops, the Federal Crop Insurance Program (FCIP) provides coverage to wholesale nursery producers. Figure 8 reports total insured liabilities for nursery coverage from 2006 to 2025, aggregated across the nursery insurance programs available during the analyzed period.[3].

Figure 8: ***United States Insurance Program Liability in U.S. Dollars for Nurseries.***



Note: The nursery category combines liabilities from the Field Grown and Container (FGC) program and the Nursery Value Select (NVS) program. FGC was the longstanding nursery insurance program and remained available through the 2024 crop year, but is no longer available beginning in 2025. NVS was introduced as a pilot program and expanded to nationwide availability by the 2025 crop year.

Source: NDSU Agricultural Risk Policy Center (ARPC) using data from USDA Risk Management Agency Summary of Business as of October 15, 2026.

[3] The nursery category combines liabilities from the Field Grown and Container (FGC) program and the Nursery Value Select (NVS) program. FGC was the longstanding nursery insurance program and remained available through the 2024 crop year, but is no longer available beginning in 2025. NVS was introduced as a pilot program and expanded to nationwide availability by the 2025 crop year.

Nursery liabilities exhibit a broadly U-shaped pattern over the analyzed period. Insured liabilities declined substantially after reaching a peak in 2008, when total nursery liabilities stood at $4.04 billion. By 2025, liabilities had fallen to $1.62 billion, down from $3.67 billion in 2006. The contraction was concentrated in the late 2000s and early 2010s (2009: -20.9 percent; 2010: -12.6 percent; 2011: -18.2 percent; 2012: -11.5 percent; 2013: -10.7 percent; 2014: -13.4 percent; 2025: -23.9 percent), before liabilities reached a trough in 2017 at $1.26 billion.

This prolonged decline was followed by a period of partial recovery. Nursery liabilities rebounded in 2018: +11.4 percent; 2019: +11.4 percent; 2020: +12.3 percent; 2021: +11.5 percent, with gains continuing more moderately through 2024. However, that recovery weakened in 2025, when total insured nursery liabilities fell back to $1.62 billion. Despite the rebound observed after the 2017 trough, nursery liabilities remain well below their mid-2000s levels, consistent with a sustained long-run reduction in insured nursery exposure.

Program Size and Growth for Forage, Range, and Pasture

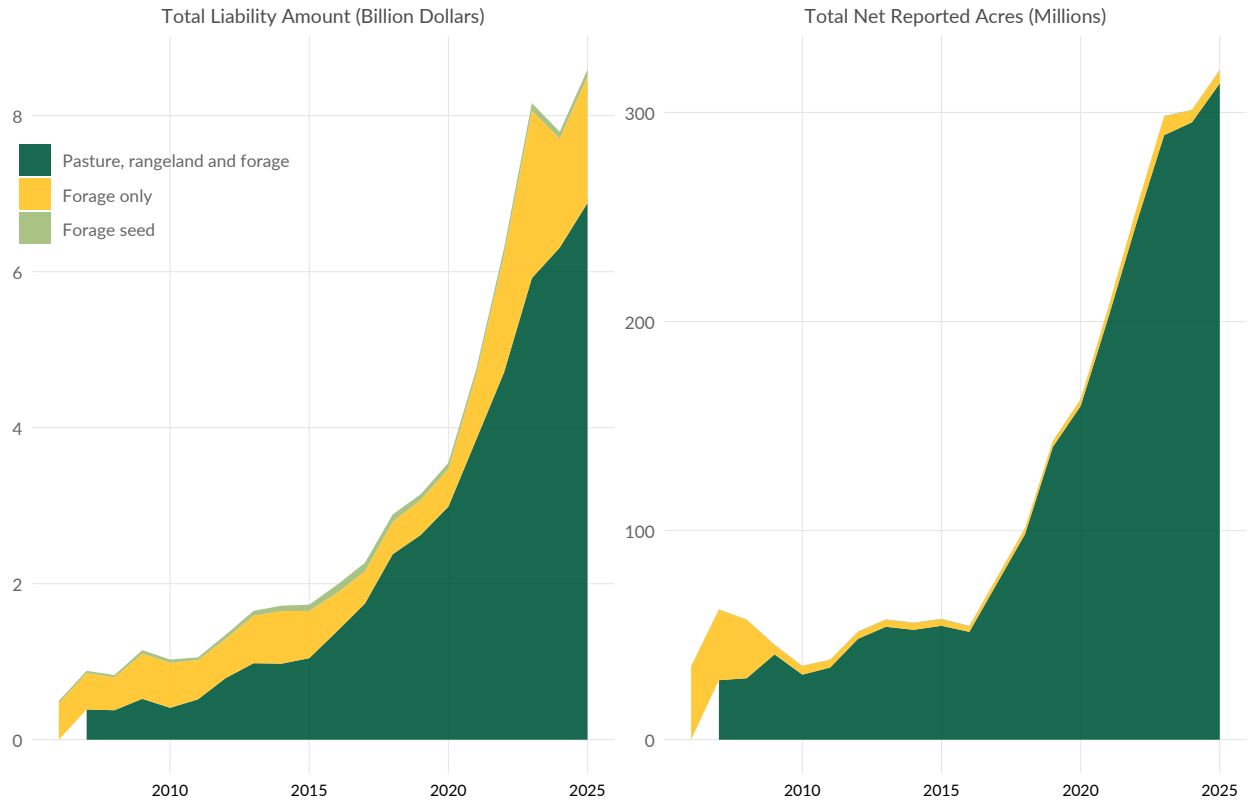
Forage-related coverage represents one of the most dynamic growth areas within the FCIP over the 2006–2025 period. Insured liabilities and net reported acres by year for forage crops are depicted in Figure 9, indicating a sharp expansion in both program scale and participation. A defining feature of forage crops is the heterogeneity in how production occurs. In some cases, forage is grown and harvested, such as hay production or forage grown for seed, while in others it is continuously grazed by livestock on pasture or rangeland. This distinction has important implications for how risk is insured.

When forage is harvested or produced for seed, an end-of-season yield can be measured, and the commodity is clearly defined. These systems are therefore covered under standard insurance plans, shown as “Forage only” and “Forage seed” in Figure 9. By contrast, continuously grazed pasture and rangeland do not produce a harvested yield. Because forage growth is consumed in place and never directly measured, traditional yield-based insurance is infeasible. To address this limitation, RMA offers the Pasture, Rangeland, and Forage (PRF) insurance plan, which provides generic, unspecified coverage for pasture, rangeland, and forage.

PRF operates as an index-based product rather than a yield-based policy. Indemnities are triggered when accumulated rainfall falls below a historical precipitation index for the producer’s vicinity, reflecting conditions under which forage growth is likely to be lower than normal. This design allows PRF to insure

production risk in systems where physical yield measurement is not possible, while still linking payments to biologically meaningful drivers of forage availability.

Figure 9: ***United States Insurance Program Liability and Net Acres Insured for Forage, Range, and Pasture.***



Source: NDSU Agricultural Risk Policy Center (ARPC) using data from USDA Risk Management Agency Summary of Business as of October 15, 2026.

These institutional differences help explain the divergent growth patterns observed across forage categories. Insured liabilities for pasture, rangeland, and forage rose sharply over the sample, increasing from $0.39 billion in 2006 to $6.88 billion in 2025, with persistent year-over-year expansion; 2009: +38.7 percent; 2011: +26.5 percent; 2012: +52.8 percent; 2013: +24.0 percent; 2016: +33.0 percent; 2017: +25.4 percent; 2018: +36.3 percent; 2019: +10.3 percent; 2020: +13.9 percent; 2021: +28.8 percent; 2022: +22.4 percent; 2023: +25.7 percent. Net reported acres followed a similar trajectory, expanding from 28.46 million acres to 313.92 million acres, indicating that growth reflects broad participation rather than valuation effects alone.

Forage-only and forage seed coverage also expanded over time but at a more moderate pace. Forage-only liabilities increased from $0.47 billion to $1.62 billion, with growth concentrated in the early

2020s following a period of volatility in the mid-2010s. Forage seed remained smaller in scale but showed steady long-run growth, rising from $0.03 billion to $0.09 billion.

Figure 9 illustrates a structural shift in forage insurance toward index-based pasture and rangeland coverage. This evolution reflects both the institutional design of PRF as an index-based product suited to continuously grazed systems and the rapid expansion of participation documented in the acreage series. A notable implication of this shift is that PRF indemnities are triggered by a shared precipitation index rather than individual yield measurements, meaning that a single weather event can generate correlated losses across large numbers of policyholders simultaneously — a form of spatially concentrated, weather-correlated exposure that differs structurally from the largely idiosyncratic risks covered under yield-based plans.

Conclusion

Over the 2006–2025 period, the Federal Crop Insurance Program expanded substantially in both scale and complexity, but the evidence indicates that this growth did not arise from a single source. Aggregate insured liabilities increased markedly, while the accompanying acreage trends varied across commodity groups. In many segments, liability growth outpaced acreage growth, a pattern consistent with rising insured values, changes in coverage intensity, and sensitivity to commodity price cycles. Field crops remained the financial anchor of the program, but much of their growth reflected deeper insured exposure per acre rather than broad acreage expansion.

Within specialty crops, the descriptive evidence is more heterogeneous. Several fruit and vegetable categories show rising liabilities alongside flat or declining acreage, whereas some nut, berry, and vegetable categories combine acreage expansion with rising liabilities. Nursery coverage is the main exception to the overall growth pattern, with aggregate insured exposure ending the period below its mid-2000s level even after a partial recovery in the late 2010s and early 2020s.

The most pronounced structural shift over the period is the expansion of pasture, rangeland, and forage insurance, which materially changed the acreage composition of the FCIP portfolio. Taken together, these results provide descriptive context for ongoing policy discussions about how commodity prices, coverage design, and participation patterns shape the program's evolving fiscal and risk profile.

Appendix A: Data and Methods

Data Sources

The analysis draws on administrative records published by the U.S. Department of Agriculture's Risk Management Agency (RMA), supplemented with farm-sector statistics from the USDA National Agricultural Statistics Service (NASS).

The primary source is the RMA Summary of Business (SOB). The SOB is an end-of-period administrative record of every crop year's insurance activity, reported by RMA at multiple levels of aggregation. This report uses the SOB at the commodity level for the national book and commodity-grouping series, and at the type, practice, and unit level where finer disaggregation is needed. SOB variables drawn into the analysis include policies sold, policies with premium, units with premium, net reported acres, companion or endorsed acres, total liability, total premium, premium subsidy, and indemnities paid.

Two supporting series are used for context and for the real-terms adjustment described below. The USDA NASS Index of Prices Received by Farmers for all-crop agricultural commodities provides the deflator used to translate nominal dollar series into 2025 price levels. NASS Census of Agriculture and NASS Survey records on planted acreage, harvested acreage, and production are retained as cross-checks against the SOB but are not introduced into the published series of this report.

The data vintage is set by the SOB pull dated October 15, 2026. All series are constructed from this single pull to keep totals internally consistent. Commodity codes, type codes, and commodity groupings follow RMA's own classification.

Sample Period and Farm Bill Decomposition

The analysis covers crop years 2006 through 2025, a span that bridges three farm bills: the 2008 Farm Bill (crop years 2008–2013), the 2014 Farm Bill (crop years 2014–2017), and the 2018 Farm Bill (crop years 2018 through 2025). Period-level averages reported in Table 1 and Table 2 are computed within these legislative windows so that the reader can see how the program looked under each policy regime. Annual values are reported separately for 2024 and 2025 to show the most recent year-over-year

movement.

Commodity Classification

Each insured commodity is assigned to one of eight groups using RMA's commodity definitions, with three targeted reclassifications to align the groups with how the program is administered.

- **Field crops:** corn, soybeans, wheat, cotton, rice, and an "other field crops" residual.
- **Fruits:** fruit production policies, separated from fruit-tree (stock) policies.
- **Nuts:** nut production policies, separated from nut-tree (stock) policies.
- **Vegetables:** all vegetable commodities.
- **Nurseries:** combined Field Grown and Container (FGC) and Nursery Value Select (NVS) policies. NVS expanded to nationwide availability in the 2025 crop year; FGC remained available through 2024 and is no longer available beginning in 2025.
- **Forage:** split into three administrative subcategories described in the next paragraph.
- **Whole-farm coverage:** Whole-Farm Revenue Protection and related farm-level products.
- **Other commodities:** a residual that absorbs commodities recoded by RMA as blank, controlled-environment, or otherwise unassigned at the time of the pull.

Two structural distinctions matter for interpretation. First, for fruits and nuts, RMA allows producers to insure the stock (trees) and the output (production quantity) under separate policies on the same acreage. To avoid double-counting acreage, the analysis sets net reported acres to zero for tree policies. Liability for tree policies is retained and reported on a liability-only axis (Figure 3 and Figure 5). Output policies for the same commodity are reported on a paired liability/acreage axis (Figure 4 and Figure 6). Second, forage coverage is reported in three administrative subcategories that reflect different insurance designs: forage only (yield-based coverage of harvested forage), forage seed (yield-based coverage of forage grown for seed), and pasture, rangeland, and forage (PRF), which is an index-based product triggered by a precipitation index for the producer's grid location rather than by measured yield. Livestock and animal-products coverage is excluded from all aggregates.

Measures of Program Size

Program size is measured using two complementary indicators. Insured liability (in nominal U.S. dollars, reported in billions or millions as appropriate to scale) captures the total dollar value of production risk transferred through the program. Net reported acres insured (in millions of acres) captures the breadth of participation. Liability and acres are used jointly: changes in liability without parallel changes in acres point to rising insured exposure per acre, while changes in acres without parallel changes in liability point to participation changes at constant per-acre exposure. Table 1 and Table 2 additionally report policies with premium and units with premium (each in millions), companion or endorsed acres (in millions), total premium, premium subsidy, indemnities (each in billions of nominal dollars and re-based dollars), and the program loss ratio defined as indemnity divided by total premium.

Growth Rates and Period Comparisons

Within each legislative period, growth rates reported in Table 2 are annual averages computed across the years that fall inside the period. Year-over-year comparisons reported alongside 2024 and 2025 are simple percent changes from the prior crop year. Nominal growth rates are reported in plain text; values shown in parentheses are the corresponding real growth rates after deflation to 2025 price levels. The loss-ratio row is suppressed in Table 2 because it is itself a ratio and growth rates on ratios are not directly comparable to growth rates on levels.

For the commodity-level sections that follow, each commodity's series is summarized by: the start-year value (2006), the end-year value (2025), the in-sample maximum and minimum and the years in which they occurred, the mean annual growth rate over the sample, and chronologies of notable growth and decline episodes defined as year-over-year percent changes whose absolute value exceeds a 10 percentage-point threshold. These summary statistics are descriptive only and carry no inferential weight.

Real-Terms Adjustments

Selected dollar-valued series are reported in both nominal terms and 2025 price levels. The deflator is the USDA NASS Index of Prices Received by Farmers for all-crop agricultural commodities, re-based to 2025.

An agricultural commodity price index is used rather than a general inflation measure because the primary objective of the adjustment is to remove the influence of agricultural commodity price movements on insured values, the same price shifts that mechanically inflate liability, premium, and indemnity figures when crop prices rise. Two caveats follow. First, because the index is itself an aggregate over crop commodities, real-terms values for any single commodity should be interpreted with caution: a real-terms grape series, for example, is deflated by an all-crops price level rather than a grape-specific one. Second, the deflator removes price-level effects but does not remove changes in coverage intensity (the share of the price-times-yield product that producers elect to insure), so real-terms growth still embeds choices about coverage level and product mix.

Scope and Limitations

The analysis is descriptive and institutional. It documents how the size and composition of the FCIP have evolved over 2006–2025 and how the underlying liability and acreage series have moved together or apart by commodity. It does not estimate causal effects of policy parameters on participation, decompose growth into a price-versus-quantity contribution, evaluate program effectiveness, or advance policy recommendations. The series presented here cannot, on their own, separately identify the relative contribution of crop prices, premium rates, coverage-level elections, supplemental endorsements, and underlying production decisions to the year-over-year changes reported in the text; where the narrative offers an interpretation of which forces are most consistent with an observed pattern, that interpretation is offered as one reading of the descriptive evidence rather than as a finding. Appendix B presents an accounting decomposition of the most recent year-over-year movement to illustrate how prices, premium rates, and coverage elections interact in shaping aggregate FCIP totals.

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About the Authors



Francis Tsiboe, Ph.D.

Dr. Francis Tsiboe is a Senior Research Economist and Program Leader with the Agricultural Risk Policy Center at North Dakota State University. His work focuses on risk management strategies and agricultural policy, with particular emphasis on how farm-level risk and insurance programs affect U.S. agricultural producers.



Rwit Chakravorty, Ph.D.

Dr. Rwit Chakravorty is a Junior Research Economist with the Agricultural Risk Policy Center at North Dakota State University. His research focuses on agricultural production economics, risk management, and market disruptions influencing input costs in domestic and global markets.



Hongxi Zhao, Ph.D.

Dr. Hongxi Zhao is a Junior Research Economist with the Agricultural Risk Policy Center at North Dakota State University. Her research focuses on efficient land use and outcomes across the urban-rural spectrum, relying on regional and environmental modeling, econometric methods, and non-market valuation.



Dylan Turner, Ph.D.

Dr. Dylan Turner is a Senior Research Economist with the Agricultural Risk Policy Center at North Dakota State University. His work focuses on agricultural policy, risk management, decision-making under uncertainty, and natural hazards, analyzing how risk and insurance markets affect producers and the broader agricultural sector.



Sandro Steinbach, Dr. Sc.

Dr. Sandro Steinbach is the Director of the Agricultural Risk Policy Center at North Dakota State University. His work focuses on agricultural trade, policy, and risk issues affecting U.S. agriculture, leading research and policy analysis that supports producers and policymakers.

About the Agricultural Risk Policy Center

The Agricultural Risk Policy Center at North Dakota State University conducts independent, evidence-based economic research to inform agricultural policy and strengthen the farm safety net. Our work focuses on evaluating risk management tools such as crop insurance and disaster assistance, analyzing market disruptions, and providing timely insights that support agricultural producers, policymakers, and industry leaders.

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Contact Us

arpc@ndsu.edu

www.ndsu.edu/agriculture/arpc

Richard H. Barry Hall 400, Fargo, ND

https://www.linkedin.com/company/ndsu-agricultural-risk-policy-center

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